

ROMANTICISM 1820–1900

Feature	Explanation	Key composers/works
Composers prize originality in their quest to express emotion and tell stories in music.	Literary works inspire opera and song, and new forms of program music, such as the tone poem.	Carl Maria von Weber, <i>Der Freischütz</i> ; Robert Schumann, <i>Kinderszenen</i> ; Richard Strauss, <i>Don Quixote</i>
Though still used, traditional forms such as symphony become less important.	Rise of freer forms of concert overture, tone poem, and suite.	Hector Berlioz, <i>Symphonie fantastique</i> ; Franz Liszt, <i>Hamlet</i> ; Peter Ilych Tchaikovsky, <i>Romeo and Juliet</i>
Opera becomes concerned with the emotions of characters and relationships.	Italian opera features dazzling singing, while German opera explores myth and symbolism.	Gioachino Rossini, <i>The Barber of Seville</i> ; Giuseppe Verdi, <i>La Traviata</i> ; Richard Wagner, <i>Tristan and Isolde</i>
Orchestra grows further to include harps, and extra wind, brass, and percussion.	New instruments offer vivid musical colors and special effects.	Hector Berlioz, <i>Harold in Italy</i> ; Richard Strauss, <i>Ein Heldenleben</i>
Piano music moves center stage as the public recital becomes popular and virtuosity flourishes.	The expressive piano attracts major composers, dazzling performers, and enthusiastic audiences.	Frédéric Chopin, <i>Preludes</i> ; Felix Mendelssohn, <i>Songs without Words</i> ; Franz Liszt, <i>Sonata in B minor</i>

1900 AND BEYOND

Feature	Explanation	Key composers/works
Music takes off in different directions.	Many composers try to break with the past.	Composers develop individual “voices.”
Orchestral music takes many different forms as the symphony declines in popularity.	Some composers write for standard orchestra; others invent their own combinations.	Richard Strauss, <i>Don Juan</i> ; Igor Stravinsky, <i>The Rite of Spring</i> ; Dmitri Shostakovich, symphonies
Neoclassicism is adopted by a few composers in some of their works.	Neoclassical composers look back to old musical styles for inspiration.	Igor Stravinsky, <i>Pulcinella</i> ; Maurice Ravel, <i>Le Tombeau de Couperin</i>
Jazz flourishes as a form in its own right.	Its influence is heard in music by mainstream composers.	Igor Stravinsky, <i>Ebony Concerto</i> ; George Gershwin, <i>Rhapsody in Blue</i>
Serialism is Arnold Schoenberg’s response to the breakdown of tonality (key structures).	Based on the 12 whole steps of a scale, it was further developed by Alban Berg and Anton Webern.	Arnold Schoenberg, <i>Five Orchestral Pieces</i> ; Alban Berg, <i>Violin Concerto</i> ; Anton Webern, <i>Variations for Orchestra</i>
Minimalism uses deliberately limited material.	Material is comprehensively repeated, developed, and transformed.	Steve Reich, <i>Clapping Music</i> ; John Adams, <i>Short Ride in a Fast Machine</i>
Musical theater becomes popular in the USA and later in Europe.	Similar to 19 th -century light opera, music theater is a popular entertainment form.	Leonard Bernstein, <i>West Side Story</i> ; Andrew Lloyd Webber, <i>Cats</i>
Technology is transforming the way music is created, performed, and shared.	Composing and performing music is no longer confined to professionals.	Karlheinz Stockhausen, <i>Stimmung</i>